INTRODUCTION TO ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE PROJECT

An Intelligent Agent-Based Framework for Real-Time Traffic Risk Assessment in Smart Cities

Name	Section	Registration Number	Roll Number
LITSA MARIOLA MENEZES	DSEC	240968043	9
SAVNI KAUL	DSEC	240968208	22
ANANYA SARAS	DSEC	240968276	24
ANJALI PRANAV	DSEC	240968338	30
VIHA DAGLIA	DSEC	240968372	33
PRAGYA KUNDU	DSEC	240968504	52

Abstract

Road traffic accidents remain a major challenge to urban safety systems worldwide. Conventional accident prediction approaches primarily rely on static machine learning models trained on historical datasets, which limit their ability to respond to dynamically changing traffic and environmental conditions. This paper proposes an intelligent agent-based framework for real-time traffic risk assessment in smart city environments. The proposed system continuously perceives traffic conditions, evaluates zone-wise risk levels, and generates timely alerts to mitigate accident-prone situations.

The framework integrates perception, decision-making, and action modules within a simulated urban environment, enabling continuous interaction with a dynamic setting. In addition, a reinforcement learning extension is explored to allow the agent to adaptively improve its alerting strategy over time. By emphasizing autonomous decision-making rather than passive prediction, the proposed framework advances toward proactive traffic safety management in smart cities.

Index Terms

Traffic risk assessment, intelligent agents, smart cities, reinforcement learning, traffic safety, real-time systems.

I. Introduction

Road traffic accidents are among the leading causes of fatalities and injuries worldwide, particularly in densely populated urban environments. With increasing vehicle density and complex road networks, ensuring traffic safety has become a critical concern for smart city initiatives. Recent advances in machine learning have enabled data-driven accident prediction models; however, most existing approaches operate offline and rely heavily on historical data.

Such static models lack the ability to adapt in real time to rapidly changing traffic conditions, including congestion levels, weather variations, and temporal factors. Moreover, these systems typically function as passive predictors rather than autonomous entities capable of continuous reasoning and decision-making.

In the context of smart cities, there is a growing need for intelligent systems that can continuously monitor traffic conditions, assess risk dynamically, and proactively generate alerts to prevent accidents. Intelligent agent-based systems provide a suitable paradigm for addressing this requirement, as they emphasize continuous perception, autonomous decision-making, and interaction with dynamic environments.

This paper proposes an intelligent agent-based framework for real-time traffic risk assessment, designed to operate within a simulated urban environment. The system evaluates zone-wise traffic risk based on evolving conditions and generates real-time alerts to support proactive traffic safety management.

II. Problem Definition

Despite significant progress in traffic accident prediction research, existing approaches exhibit several limitations:

-Heavy dependence on static historical datasets

-Limited adaptability to real-time traffic and environmental changes

-Lack of interpretability in risk-based decision-making

-Vulnerability to failures or unavailability of real-time data sources such as sensors or APIs

These limitations motivate the development of a robust, adaptive, and explainable framework capable of continuously monitoring traffic conditions and assessing risk in real time through autonomous decision-making.

III. Objectives

The primary objectives of this research are as follows:

-To design an intelligent agent-based framework for real-time traffic risk assessment

-To model an urban traffic environment as a set of dynamically evolving zones

-To compute zone-wise traffic risk scores using rule-based heuristics and learned policies.

-To generate real-time alerts and visual risk indicators through a monitoring interface

-To investigate the role of reinforcement learning in improving alert effectiveness over time

IV. Proposed Framework

A. System Architecture

The proposed system follows a classical intelligent agent architecture comprising three core components: perception, decision-making, and action. The agent continuously interacts with a dynamic environment, observes traffic-related conditions, reasons about risk levels, and performs appropriate actions in the form of alerts.

B. Perception Module

The perception module continuously acquires environmental observations, referred to as percepts. These include traffic density, weather conditions, time of day, and historical risk indicators. Percepts may be obtained from real-time data sources such as APIs or generated through simulation to ensure system robustness in the absence of live data feeds.

Optional deep learning-based perception models may be incorporated at this stage to estimate traffic conditions or accident likelihood from visual or aggregated data sources.

C. Decision-Making Module

The decision-making module evaluates traffic risk using a combination of rule-based heuristics and weighted risk models inspired by traffic safety research. The agent maps percepts to internal state representations and assigns dynamic risk scores to each traffic zone.

In advanced configurations, outputs from learned models may be integrated as supplementary inputs to enhance risk estimation. The decision-making process emphasizes interpretability and adaptability rather than purely statistical prediction.

D. Action Module

Based on computed risk levels, the action module generates alerts when predefined risk thresholds are exceeded. High-risk zones are highlighted on a simulated city map, and alerts are updated continuously as environmental conditions change. These actions represent the agent's response to perceived risk in the environment.

V. Simulation Environment

A simulated urban environment is constructed in which the city is divided into discrete traffic zones. Each zone is associated with dynamically changing parameters representing traffic density, weather conditions, and temporal factors. This simulation enables controlled experimentation and systematic evaluation of the proposed framework without reliance on real-world deployment.

VI. Reinforcement Learning Extension

To enhance adaptability, a reinforcement learning component is introduced wherein the agent learns optimal alerting strategies through repeated interaction with the environment. The agent receives feedback based on the effectiveness of issued alerts, and reward functions are defined to encourage timely, accurate, and meaningful risk warnings.

Over multiple episodes, the agent refines its policy for risk-based alert generation, enabling improved performance under varying traffic conditions.

VII. Expected Outcomes

The expected outcomes of this research include:

-A functional intelligent agent-based framework for real-time traffic risk assessment.

-Dynamic visualization of zone-wise traffic risk levels.

-Improved adaptability compared to static accident prediction models.

-Insights into the applicability of reinforcement learning for traffic safety decision-making.

VIII. Conclusion

This paper presents an intelligent agent-based framework for real-time traffic risk assessment in smart city environments. By integrating continuous perception, autonomous decision-making, and adaptive learning, the proposed system moves

beyond traditional accident prediction models toward proactive traffic safety management. The framework provides a scalable and extensible foundation for future intelligent transportation systems.

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